

In the Scripture there are 160 references to the word fast or some variation of the it.

WHO FASTED IN SCRIPTURE?

The Children of Israel:

[Judges 20:26](#)

Then all the children of Israel, that is, all the people, went up and came to the house of God[20:26 Or [Bethel]] and wept. They sat there before the LORD and **fasted** that day until evening; and they offered burnt offerings and peace offerings before the LORD.

[1 Samuel 7:6](#)

So they gathered together at Mizpah, drew water, and poured it out before the LORD. And they **fasted** that day, and said there, "We have sinned against the LORD." And Samuel judged the children of Israel at Mizpah.

[1 Samuel 31:13](#)

Then they took their bones and buried them under the tamarisk tree at Jabesh, and **fasted** seven days.

[2 Samuel 1:12](#)

And they mourned and wept and **fasted** until evening for Saul and for Jonathan his son, for the people of the LORD and for the house of Israel, because they had fallen by the sword.

David:

[2 Samuel 12:16](#)

David therefore pleaded with God for the child, and David **fasted** and went in and lay all night on the ground.

[2 Samuel 12:21](#)

Then his servants said to him, "What is this that you have done? You **fasted** and wept for the child while he was alive, but when the child died, you arose and ate food."

[2 Samuel 12:22](#)

And he said, "While the child was alive, I **fasted** and wept; for I said, "Who can tell whether the LORD will be gracious to me, that the child may live?"

[Psalms 69:10](#)

When I wept and chastened my soul with **fasting**, That became my reproach.

[Psalms 109:24](#)

My knees are weak through **fasting**, And my flesh is feeble from lack of fatness.

Ahab:

[1 Kings 21:27](#)

So it was, when Ahab heard those words, that he tore his clothes and put sackcloth on his body, and **fasted** and lay in sackcloth, and went about mourning.

The servants of Saul:

[1 Chronicles 10:12](#)

all the valiant men arose and took the body of Saul and the bodies of his sons; and they

brought them to Jabesh, and buried their bones under the tamarisk tree at Jabesh, and **fasted** seven days.

The prophet Ezra:

[Ezra 8:23](#)

So we **fasted** and entreated our God for this, and He answered our prayer.

[Ezra 9:5](#)

At the evening sacrifice I arose from my **fasting**; and having torn my garment and my robe, I fell on my knees and spread out my hands to the LORD my God.

Nehemiah:

[Nehemiah 1:4](#)

So it was, when I heard these words, that I sat down and wept, and mourned for many days; I was **fasting** and praying before the God of heaven.

Mordecai:

[Esther 4:1](#)

When Mordecai learned all that had happened, he tore his clothes and put on sackcloth and ashes, and went out into the midst of the city. He cried out with a loud and bitter cry.

Zechariah and the Priests:

[Zechariah 7:5](#)

"Say to all the people of the land, and to the priests: "When you **fasted** and mourned in the fifth and seventh months during those seventy years, did you really fast for Me?

The Prophet Daniel:

[Daniel 9:3](#)

Then I set my face toward the Lord God to make request by prayer and supplications, with **fasting**, sackcloth, and ashes.

The Prophet Joel:

[Joel 2:12](#)

"Now, therefore," says the LORD, "Turn to Me with all your heart, With **fasting**, with weeping, and with mourning."

Jesus:

[Matthew 4:2](#)

And when He had **fasted** forty days and forty nights, afterward He was hungry.

The Pharisees and the disciples of John The Baptist:

[Mark 2:18](#)

The disciples of John and of the Pharisees were **fasting**. Then they came and said to Him, "Why do the disciples of John and of the Pharisees fast, but Your disciples do not fast?"

Those who desire to cast out devils:

[Mark 9:29](#)

So He said to them, "This kind can come out by nothing but prayer and **fasting**."

Cornelius:

[Acts 10:30](#)

So Cornelius said, "Four days ago I was **fasting** until this hour; and at the ninth hour I prayed in my house, and behold, a man stood before me in bright clothing,

The Apostles:

[Acts 13:2](#)

As they ministered to the Lord and **fasted**, the Holy Spirit said, "Now separate to Me Barnabas and Saul for the work to which I have called them."

[Acts 13:3](#)

Then, having **fasted** and prayed, and laid hands on them, they sent them away.